

词汇: *relationships* 人际关系

- 1 If you've ever felt the benefit of a loved one's warm **embrace** when you're feeling stressed or sad, it might not surprise you that strong relationships can **do wonders** for your wellbeing. Research over the years has shown that people with strong **social ties** tend to be healthier, but a 2025 study, published in *Brain, Behaviour and Immunity* now suggests that it could also slow down the ageing process.
- 2 Researchers in the United States came up with a measure called '**cumulative** social advantage', which **takes into account** the benefits of maintaining strong, supportive relationships over time, rather than just newer relationships. They looked at things like support from parents growing up, participation in the community, and **ongoing** support from friends and family. People who had these things were more likely to have a younger **biological age** and less **inflammation** in the body. Co-author of the study, Anthony Ong, says "Think of social connections like a retirement account. The earlier you start investing and the more consistently you contribute, the greater your **returns**".
- 3 So, how are friendships so powerful? Humans have evolved over hundreds of thousands of years as social beings – we're **wired** for connection. For our ancestors, being part of a group wasn't just about having company, it kept us safe and made it easier to find and share food and raise **offspring**. And it now appears that these connections affect our bodies on a biological, **cellular** level.
- 4 "While it is always good to make new friends, there is often a greater sense of trust and **dependability** with people you've known for a longer time," says Hillary Ammon, a clinical psychologist at the Center for Anxiety and Women's Emotional Wellness. Of course, maintaining relationships as we get older can be difficult as people closest to us move away, or prioritise other things. Hillary says not to worry if your friends are newer, as connection is what really matters. A strong **network** of friends not only adds years to your life, it adds life to your years.

## 测验与练习

### 一、为本文选择总结句。

What is this article about?

### 二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Which is the best definition for the phrase 'cumulative social advantage'?
  - a. networking with people in the workplace
  - b. the strength of your social connections over a lifetime
  - c. how well you get on with people
2. Which of these is NOT mentioned as part of 'cumulative social advantage'?
  - a. support from parents growing up
  - b. support from teachers at school
  - c. ongoing support from friends and family
3. Humans evolved as social beings to avoid feeling lonely.
  - a. True
  - b. False
  - c. Not given
4. According to Hillary Ammon, what advantage do older friends have over newer friends?
  - a. Older friends are easier to trust and depend on.
  - b. Older friends move away and prioritise other things.
  - c. Older friends know you better.
5. What does the author mean when they say a strong network of friends 'adds life to your years'?
  - a. Friends make the years last longer.
  - b. Friends make us live longer.
  - c. Friends make life more fun and exciting.

### 三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Maintaining relationships over a lifetime can keep our **1)** \_\_\_\_\_ young and decrease risk of body **2)** \_\_\_\_\_, according to a new study. So, it turns out that having a supportive **3)** \_\_\_\_\_ of people around you can **4)** \_\_\_\_\_ for your health and wellbeing. Next time you see your loved ones, make sure to give them a warm **5)** \_\_\_\_\_.

|                      |                |                       |
|----------------------|----------------|-----------------------|
| <b>dependability</b> | <b>embrace</b> | <b>inflammation</b>   |
| <b>network</b>       |                | <b>ongoing</b>        |
| <b>do wonders</b>    |                | <b>biological age</b> |

(答案见词汇表后)

## 词汇表

|                                      |                   |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>embrace</b>                       | 拥抱                |
| <b>do wonders</b>                    | 产生奇妙的作用，对...有很大帮助 |
| <b>social tie</b>                    | 社会联系              |
| <b>cumulative</b>                    | 累积的               |
| <b>take (something) into account</b> | 考虑到，顾及            |
| <b>ongoing</b>                       | 持续存在的             |
| <b>biological age</b>                | 生理年龄              |
| <b>inflammation</b>                  | 炎症                |
| <b>return</b>                        | 回报，收益             |
| <b>wired</b>                         | 具有...天性的          |
| <b>offspring</b>                     | 后代                |
| <b>cellular</b>                      | 细胞的               |
| <b>dependability</b>                 | 可依靠性              |
| <b>network</b>                       | 网络                |

## 答案

### 一、为本文选择总结句。

This article is about how maintaining strong social relationships over a lifetime can slow down the ageing process.

### 二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b.** ...a measure called 'cumulative social advantage', which takes into account the benefits of **maintaining strong, supportive relationships over time**, rather than just newer relationships.

2. **b.** They looked at things like **support from parents growing up**, participation in the community, and **ongoing support from friends and family**.

3. **b. False.** For our ancestors, being part of a group **wasn't just about having company**, it kept us safe and made it easier to find and share food, and raise offspring.

4. **a.** ... there is often a greater sense of **trust and dependability** with people you've known for a longer time.

5. **c.** This meaning is inferred because if you 'add life to something', it means to make it more interesting and enjoyable.

### 三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Maintaining relationships over a lifetime can keep our **biological age** young and decrease risk of body **inflammation**, according to a new study. So, it turns out that having a supportive **network** of people around you can **do wonders** for your health and wellbeing. Next time you see your loved ones, make sure to give them a warm **embrace**.